

Disclaimer: I am not such an expert. This is just to give an idea.

Smart Networking & Professional Resilience

Presentation Preparation

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Job Stress Is Real (Yes, even for PhDs, if not more!)

CHALLENGES AND OBSTACLES

Nature's survey of graduate students highlights the rewards and challenges of scientific training. Despite financial struggles, long work hours and widespread mental-health issues, the majority of respondents are still satisfied with their programmes.

What concerns have you had since you started your graduate degree?



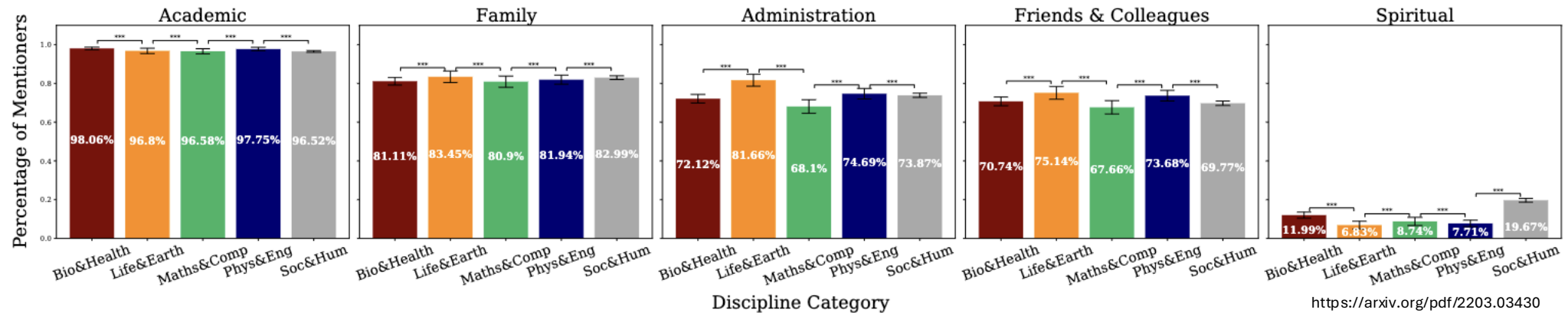
<https://www.nature.com/articles/d41586-022-03394-0>



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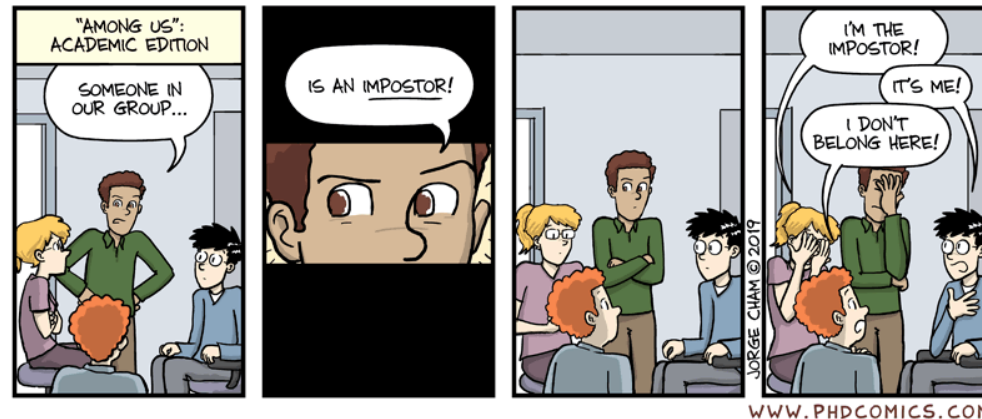
Find Your Academic Support Group Early



Good academic support group is associated with better well-being during PhD

Number one rule of academia: your colleagues are your allies not your rivals

So, the **smart networking starts with your academic peer groups!**



How to Cope With Job Rejections?

What Actually Happens To Most Applications

- You applied, then rejected, so what happens?
 - Rejection fatigue might happen
 - Not take it too personal (seriously!)

Stage in the Hiring Funnel	What Happens Behind the Scenes	What It Means for You
Application submitted	Resume enters ATS queue with hundreds of others	No human has seen it yet
Automated screening	Resume filtered by keywords, job level, location	Qualified candidates can be filtered out
Recruiter review	Small subset reviewed manually	Visibility depends on alignment and timing
Hiring manager shortlist	Internal candidates often prioritized	Silence may have nothing to do with fit
Interview selection	Only a fraction contacted	Non-response is statistically normal

Common Thought Patterns And Healthier Ways To Reframe Them

Thought Trap	What It Sounds Like	More Accurate Reframe
Personalization	"There must be something wrong with me"	"This role likely had constraints I can't see"
Catastrophizing	"I'll never get hired"	"This outcome reflects timing, not destiny"
Comparison bias	"Everyone else is moving forward"	"I'm only seeing highlight reels"
Mind reading	"They didn't like me"	"No feedback means no signal"

1. Separate self-worth from the job
2. Rejection is an event, not a verdict
3. Shifting strategy instead of blaming
4. Implement quality over quantity

What is Smart Networking?

- Genuine, mutual professional networking strategy
 - ~~Not a cold message to get hired~~
 - Meet-ups, groups or communities to connect
 - Cultivate strong and trustful digital presence
 - Pay-it-forward mindset
 - Stay targeted
 - Focusing on advice rather than employment
 - Use social media wisely to find and connect people
- **Informal interviews**
 - Gain industry&role insights
 - Build network proactively
 - Chance to introduce yourself



Hi! I'm Bob. I create comics about work.

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Helpful Resources

- **iBiology, networking and job hunt tips:** <https://www.ibiology.org/professional-development/job-hunting-in-industry/>
- **Peer groups are important for the mental stability and resilience,** <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2203.03430>
- **Informational interview:** <https://afteryourphd.com/informational-interviews/> and detailed questions to be prepared: <https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/15-informational-interview-questions-phds-nervous-sorbara-phd>
- **How to cope with job rejection fatigue:** <https://blog.theinterviewguys.com/coping-with-job-rejection-fatigue/>
- **Why "No"s are not personal:** <https://staffingbystarboard.com/blog/the-psychology-of-rejection-how-to-handle-100-applications-with-no-response/>
- **LinkedIn discussions:** <https://www.linkedin.com/top-content/career/job-search-and-career-transition/networking-strategies-for-a-targeted-job-search/>

Acknowledgements

I prepared these ppts to give a detailed idea based on the discussions we had during the meetings with the incredible organizing committee of ECSC2026:

- **Dr. Pradeep Eranti**
- **Paula Camargo Romero**
- **Victor Grentzinger**
- Ankita Murmu
- Haseeb Manzoor
- Estefania Torrejón
- Elisabeth Hellec

